



Internship Resume Building Session 2025- 26 IIT MADRAS



General Pointers

- Your resume's free space is **extremely valuable**.
- Rome wasn't built in a day, so is your resume - it will require multiple iterations (In general 10-11 versions)
- A resume screen is the easiest way to reject a candidate (if it does not follow certain rules or has these common mistakes)

General Points

Fonts and Color Scheme:

- **Font Size:**

- It is preferable to have a font size between 9 to 12.
- Best: Font size of '10' for the content and '12' for the headings
- Fonts that are preferred by most:
 - Sans Serif fonts like **Calibri**, **Arial**, Tahoma, Verdana, Helvetica
 - Serif fonts like: Garamond, **Times New Roman**

- **Size of Paper:**

- Keep the size of the resume strictly within an A4 sheet (Don't try to have a bigger-sized paper to include the content; Trust us the firms can figure out)

- **Number of colors:**

- A maximum of 3 colors (this includes the background color as well).
- Please use shades of the same color rather than using completely different ones.
- Best colors on a resume are **Black**, **White**, and **Blue**. They appear modern, trustworthy and grab the reader's attention without being distracting.

Formatting content:

- Try to exclude **blank spaces** as much as possible. There is no hard rule as to how much white space you should have in the resume. It is recommended to have 450-600 words on your resume in total (a 2-2.5 minute reading)
- Quantify your achievements, results, and strategies as much as possible (Putting out numbers is important).
 - Example : **Guided 1300+ students for Intern Season'22 while managing 20+ company tests & interviews**
- Always use bullet points for content within a particular sub-section. Paragraphs make the resumes seem cluttered.
- Use Action Verbs to describe the points. Never write complete sentences or repeat content in the resume. (A list of action verbs for different profiles and skill sets have been provided at the end of this document.)
- Use the **STAR** and **CAR** formats to structure your points. STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result and CAR: Challenge, Action, Result.

Sections of a resume :

Headings/sections to be included in a resume are:

Education/Scholastic Information and Achievements:

- Make an exhaustive list of achievements, rank them by magnitude, and group them section-wise; minor achievements add value in sections where the resume is weak
 - School & College information with Final Percentage and Interim CGPA (For calculations, rounding is not permitted) JEE, KVPY, NTSE, Olympiad, and
 - Other competitive exam achievements (ex-CFA)
- Skills (primarily technical and software skills are included in the section)

Professional Experience (Such as internships/jobs previously held)

- Corporate/Startup Internships

Projects

- Research Internships and Projects

Courses

- Curriculum and External Courses (on Udemy, Coursera, etc.,)

Positions of Responsibilities

Co-curricular Activities

- Case competitions, Hackathons, Technical Conferences

Extracurricular activities

NOTE: It is not necessary to include all of the above sections. Analyze your strengths and create profile-specific resumes.

Common Mistakes in a resume

- More than one page
- Other sizes Pages, not A4.
- Putting abbreviations but no expansion anywhere on the resume (abbreviation expansion as a footnote)
- More than one sentence per line/bullet point, making paragraphs (Every point must be of one line and No Paragraph)
- Inconsistent formatting - every section has a different font and size.
- Should be easy on the eyes to read - Avoid walls of text with minimal spacing

- Avoid grammatical and spelling errors at all costs (bare minimum expectation)
- Start adding random “special skills” when it feels the resume is too short.

Customizing for Job Profiles

Core:

- Mention the core courses and labs relevant to the profile
- Important projects done under the department
- Relevant software that is known to you related to your discipline
- Relevant competitions won

Non - Core:

Consulting

- Analytical abilities
- Communication skills and Team work
- Academic performance
- Spikes in any field

I-Banking (Front-end)

- Analytical abilities
- Department/ Specialization
- Academic performance
- Communication skills

FMCG

- Working in teams
- Academic performance
- Grasp of technical concepts

Tech

- Knowledge of concepts
- Academic performance
- Analytical abilities
- Programming languages known

I-Banking (Back-end)

- Problem/puzzle-solving skills
- Communication skills
- Working in stressful situations

IT

- Knowledge of concepts
- Academic performance
- Analytical abilities
- Programming languages known

Sample Resume

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS			
EDUCATION & SCHOLASTIC ACHIEVEMENTS			
PROGRAM	INSTITUTION	CGPA/%	YEAR
Metallurgical and Materials Engineering (B.Tech) IDDD: Complex Systems & Dynamics (M.Tech)	Indian Institute of Technology Madras		
Class XII (CBSE ¹)	Maharishi Vidya Mandir Sr. Sec. School		
Class X (CBSE ¹)	Maharishi Vidya Mandir Sr. Sec. School		
• Recipient of the Smt. Subbalakshmi Ananta Narayana Award for scoring overall highest in English in AISSCE² (Class XII, CBSE¹) • Earned Distinction in Mathematics (Top 10%) in National Level Olympiad conducted by University of New South Wales Global • Secured Top 5 percentile in Programming, Data Structures and Algorithms course by NPTEL³ and earned Elite + Gold certificate			
FINANCE & QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH			
Investment Analyst Intern, BB Advisories		(May'23 - July'23)	
• Researched & analysed forex currencies to understand market trend & identified potential investment opportunities for profits • Assessed risk factors in forex market, created investment reports by performing technical analysis on previous client trades • Managed client portfolio, traded gold & silver alongside forex currencies on live market and generated 14% profit over 1 month			
Chief Editor, Investment Etc Magazine, Finance Club, IIT Madras			
• Spearheaded a campus ambassador program to collaborate with finance clubs & expand outreach to other universities in India • Formulated vision to officially publish and launch paper-back version bi-yearly and increase subscriber base by 15% per annum • Included finance career preparation material and modified team structure with ambassadors & designers to increase outreach			
Inflation model and analysis of suitable monetary policies		(Jan'23 - May'23)	
• Developed payoff functions and probed factors affecting inflation target using industry trends in the Russia-Ukraine war period • Generated predictive model using python to graphically represent inflation forecasting considering hawk-ish environment • Suggested monetary policies to control inflation hike from 150 points to 75 points due to increase in taxation and interest rates			
Financial Markets Experience Program (FMPE), Finlatics		(May'22 - June'22)	
• Performed market research analysis and evaluated financial indicators for the Healthcare and Food & Beverage industry trends • Achieved 10% profits in portfolio management including risk assessment, asset allocation and performance measurement • Awarded letter of recommendation and conducted live market trading in financial markets using indices from BSE and NSE			
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE			
R&D Intern, The Titan Company, Hosur		(May'22 - July'22)	
• Leveraged rare-earth metal alloys to improve process efficiency from 85% to 95% of Zamak-5 alloy high pressure die casting • Proposed new composition of brass alloy for watch cases using material characterization to reduce production costs by 20% • Researched on various anodization methods for LM-5 aluminium alloy and developed reports based on dye - characterization			
Product Management Intern, Banao Technologies		(Nov'22 - April'23)	
• Modeled a product development life cycle to track the progress of a product deployment from ideation phase to execution • Managed a 6-member team; Conducted market competitor analysis and user-review analysis to identify product opportunities • Handled 3 technology company projects from Duonut, Panotam CGI and E-Pacts with a minimum of 13% increase in consumers			
POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY			
Head, Career Development Cell (CDC), IIT Madras	<i>CDC, IIT M focuses on improving career guidance for aspirants in technical and non-technical fields</i> • Launched Department Academic Mentorship Program to spread awareness on core opportunities • Created and released resources & tests for Intern Season'23 in collaboration with clubs & vendors • Introduced Student Interest Groups (SIGs) to guide 200+ CAT, UPSC and higher studies' aspirants		
IPR Coordinator, Placement & Internship Cell, IIT Madras (May'22 - Feb'23)	<i>Industrial and Public Relations (IPR) team handles non-core placement and internship opportunities</i> • Handled outreach for 120+ companies in sectors including consult, finance, software and trading • Generated 30% conversion rate and achieved 5x increase in offers during Placement Season • Guided 1300+ students for Intern Season'22 while managing 20+ company tests & interviews		
Head of Secretariat, Events & Outreach, SECC, IIT Madras (May'22 - Feb'23)	<i>Student Ethics & Constitution Commission (SECC) enforces student constitution to ensure equality</i> • Organised general body elections for 9000+ students; Steered online voting system for the 1st time • Launched 'Voices of State', a lecture series inaugurated by Chief Election Commissioner of India • Increased outreach by 28% on social media and conducted collaborative events with 300+ football		
Exhibitions' Head, Shows and Exhibitions, Shastra, IIT Madras	<i>Shastra is the largest student-run technical fest and one of its kind with ISO 9001:2015 certification</i> • Coordinated with 500+ colleges and managed offline exhibitions with footfall of 50,000+ audience • Achieved 80% increase in number of companies at Shastra Jrs'22 and 34% increase at Shastra • Collaborated with US embassy for international exhibitors and managed a budget of INR 2 lakhs		
EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES			
Music	Band	• Lead singer of 'Purple Margherita' band; Top band at Inter-IIT cultural's'23 representing IIT Madras • Placed 1st in MoodIndigo'23, 2nd in Saarang'23; Received over INR 1,00,000 in prizes and awards	
	Vocals	• Professionally trained in Carnatic Music for 9 years; Represented IIT Madras for 3+ years as Vocalist • Won 1st in western solo singing at Litsoc'23; 1 amongst top 10 vocalists at Inter-IIT solo singing • Heading IIT Madras Acapella Contingent as Vocal Fry Captain for 10+ cultural festivals year-long	
Sports	Table-Tennis	• Selected to represent IIT Madras for Table-Tennis amongst 100+ players, with 2 years of training	
	Karate	• Qualified for the Green Belt from Shito-Ryu Karate Academy with training for more than four years	

CBSE¹ - Central Board of Secondary Education; AISSCE² - All India Senior School Certificate Examination; NPTEL³ - National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning

Review

Getting the resume reviewed is necessary to understand how an average reader reacts to it.

Who should review your resume?

- Seniors
- Friends capable of judging your resume well
- Family members working in the corporate world

Getting the right feedback

- 'Feel' of the resume: what personality and skills it reflect
- Can it be shortened? Is it repetitive?
- Does it draw attention to the desired points?

The Bottom line

- You have to be comfortable with what your resume says about you
- Be true in the resume and be prepared with a few examples to validate your claims
- Know your resume thoroughly



Common Misconceptions

Stay clear of common misconceptions and clarify with reliable sources

WHAT YOU THOUGHT

- Recruiters don't know which activities on campus are really worthwhile
- Mediocre PT/project work can be exaggerated to make it impressive
- I must mention all events I 'participated' in to show enthusiasm



WHAT IS TRUE

- Most firms have IITM alumni who are up-to-date with campus trends
- Recruiters know what to ask you to figure it out
- Participation => Did not win; put only achievements



Action Verbs

For Engineering/Technical roles:

• Conceptualised	• Computed	• Extrapolated
• Predicted	• Installed	• Engineered
• Calculated	• Segmented	• Restructured
• Arbitrated	• Estimated	• Overhauled
• Devised	• Assembled	• Unified
• Visualised	• Debugged	• Customised
• Standardised	• Steered Tested	• Validated
• Diagnosed	• Troubleshooted	• Automated
• Strengthened	• Deployed	• Architected
• Discovered	• Added	•

Design and Creative Skills:

• Acted	• Correlated	• Customised
• Designed	• Developed	• Directed
• Established	• Fashioned	• Illustrated
• Instituted	• Integrated	• Performed
• Planned	• Proved	• Revised
• Revitalised	• Streamlined	• Structured
• Shaped	• Tabulated	• Validated

Financial Skills:

• Administered	• Allocated	• Analysed
• Appraised	• Audited	• Balanced
• Budgeted	• Calculated	• Computed
• Managed	• Planned	• Projected
• Researched	• Restructured	• Modelled

Process Improvement, Consulting and Operations:

• Combined	• Consolidated	• Converted
• Decreased	• Devised	• Eliminated
• Expanded	• Improved	• Increased
• Innovated	• Minimised	• Maximised
• Modernised	• Recommended	• Refined
• Reorganised	• Resolved	• Revised
• Serviced	• Simplified	• Transformed
• Unified	• Widened	• Broadened
• Revamped	• Collaborated	• Trimmed

Problem Solving Skills:

• Arranged	• Composed	• Conceived
• Controlled	• Co-ordinated	• Investigated
• Itemised	• Operated	• Prepared
• Processed	• Produced	• Reviewed
• Scheduled	• Simplified	• Transformed

Research and Analysis Skills:

• Classified	• Assessed	• Collated
• Defined	• Devised	• Evaluated
• Forecasted	• Identified	• Traced
• Researched	• Tested	• Interpreted
• Verified	• Uncovered	• Clarified
• Collected	• Critiqued	• Diagnosed
• Extracted	• Inspected	• Inspired
• Organised	• Reviewed	• Summarised
• Surveyed	• Systemised	• Interviewed

Management Skills:

• Chaired	• Consolidated	• Assigned
• Delegated	• Contracted	• Directed
• Executed	• Guided	• Planned
• Prioritised	• Produced	• Recommended
• Scheduled	• Supervised	• Managed

Entrepreneurial Skills:

• Created	• Composed	• Conceived
• Established	• Founded	• Generated
• Implemented	• Launched	• Led
• Opened	• Originated	• Pioneered
• Promoted	• Started	• Released

Appendix: FAQs

Q. How do I justify a low CGPA?

A. Prove that time was spent in other worthwhile activities which developed adequate intellectual and social skills

Q. How do I balance between exaggeration and understatement?

A. Get it reviewed by friends who are unaware of your background. Remember that you must be able to carry off the image that your resume portrays.



Q. Should I include maximum activities to prove that I didn't waste time?

A. Show maximum output, not activities. Focus on excellence, not just enthusiasm.

Q. Should I add major achievements at school level?

A. Only if you have no other significant achievement in that section, else avoid

B. It runs the risk of pointing out that you had potential but didn't utilize it in the last 4-5 years

Q. How detailed should descriptions of projects/achievements be?

A. Enough to reflect skills and results, avoid unnecessary details that dilute focus

Q. Which course projects should I include?

A. Those that reflect achievements or innovation more than expected

B. Those involving a major concept that you would like to discuss in the interview



Q. How technical should the language/ terminology be?

A. Avoid technical details as the recruiter might not be familiar with it, focus on time/ cost saved and other outputs

B. Avoid IITM-specific terms or events that the recruiter might not be familiar with

Q. How do I know which skill/ achievement/ project can be removed?

A. Just remove it and see how much difference it makes and if the skill reflected by it can be effectively brought out using some other item

B. Avoid repeating achievements in the same field (e.g. seminar and BTP in the same topic, coordinator and Core in the same fest).

It is obvious that you can't reach the higher level without excelling in the lower one!